

Official report of ROMANIA

on the application of the

1974 Recommendation concerning education for international understanding, co-operation and peace and education relating to human rights and fundamental freedoms

I. Information about the respondent

Country:

Romania

Organization:

Ministry of Education and Research (MoER)

Date of submission:

23.12.2020

II. Other contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire

Please indicate below the names of other organizations and contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire.

Government institutions including other Ministries (please specify):

National human rights institutions (please specify):

Local and regional authorities responsible for education (please specify):

Other local and regional authorities (please specify):

Organizations representing education stakeholders (e.g. teachers, students, parents, etc.) (please specify):

Other civil society organizations (please specify):

Others (please specify):

III. Questionnaire

A. Laws and policies (preamble and paras 4 and 7 of the 1974 Recommendation)

A1a. Please describe any specific national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal framework(s) in your country that govern the promotion of global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes¹ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

In Romania, there is a general legal framework which governs the promotion of global citizenship education (GCED) and education for sustainable development (ESD). The documents mentioned below reflect directly or indirectly the topics of GCED and ESD, by addressing the principles and instruments of the national education system with a focus on knowledge, skills, attitudes and behaviours at macro and micro levels, as follows:

- **The Constitution of Romania** (2003) establishes the general legal framework, including indirect references to GCED and ESD in Chapter I, art. 4 (*People's unity and equality among citizens*); Chapter II (*Fundamental rights and freedoms*). The Constitution refers to: cultural diversity and tolerance; human rights education; peace and non-violence. In this regard, the Constitution addresses the right of parents to educate their children according to their own views (art. 29); prohibits hate-speech, discrimination, separatism or public violence based on national, racial, class or religious criteria (art. 30, para. 7); provides for the right to education through mandatory and free general education for all children (art. 32, para. 1 & 4), the right of national minorities to study in their mother tongue (art. 32, para. 3) and the right to religious freedom (art. 32, para. 7).
- **The Law of National Education no. 1/2011**, with the subsequent amendments and completions, includes provisions regarding the general organisation and functioning of the educational system in Romania, providing for equal access rights for all citizens to all levels and types of education, without any form discrimination. The law includes provisions which address GCED and ESD topics (diversity, equality, human rights etc.), through art. 2, para 3 (educational ideal), para. 4 and para. 5 (equal access to education); art. 3 (principles governing education); art. 4 (outcomes); art. 68 (competencies addressed through the national curriculum). The provisions of the Law refer generally to the national educational as a whole, as well as to each level of education. Civic and moral values, as well as respect for the natural, social and cultural environment are the pillars of national education, thus addressing the themes of cultural diversity and tolerance, human rights education, peace and non-violence, climate change education, environmental sustainability, sustainable consumption and production, being reflected in the principles of education: equity in access to education, respect for national cultural identity and for intercultural dialogue, conservation and promoting the of national identity and of cultural values of the Romanian people, recognising, conservation and ensuring rights for ethnic minorities with a view to development of their ethnic, cultural, linguistic and religious identity, social inclusion, promoting health education, preventing bullying in educational environment. Additionally, the final educational outputs reflect the themes under GCED and ESD through: social integration and active citizen participation in society; participation to sustainable economy development; development of a conception of life, based on humanistic and scientific values, on the national and universal culture and on the stimulation of the intercultural dialogue; education in the spirit of dignity, tolerance and of respect for human rights and his fundamental freedoms; cultivating sensitivity to human issues, to moral and civic values and to respect for nature and the natural, social and cultural environment. According to the National Education Law sustainable development of the society together with plenary development of the individual are the main finalities of the lifelong learning.

¹ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

- **Government Ordinance no. 137/2000 regarding the prevention and sanctioning of all forms of discrimination**, with the subsequent amendments and completions (2014), includes provisions regarding the framework for ensuring the respect of citizens' rights and freedoms and, indirectly, to education on these topics, through: Chapter I (*Principles and definitions*); Chapter II (*Special dispositions*), Section III (*Access to education*), Section V (*Right to personal dignity*), Section VI (*National Council for Combating Discrimination*). The Ordinance promotes: non-discriminatory access to education, the principles of equality among citizens, exclusion of privileges and discrimination, as well as the establishment of National Council for Combating Discrimination as state authority in the field of preventing discrimination. The provisions are generally applicable, without mentioning specifically levels of education. They concern themes such as: cultural diversity and tolerance, gender equality education, human rights education, peace and non-violence, human survival and well-being.
- **Law 272/2004 regarding the protection and promotion of child's rights**, with the subsequent amendments and completions (2014), creates the national legal framework for promoting and respecting child's rights, including indirect reference to aspects regarding GCED and ESD (cultural diversity and tolerance, health education, human rights education, peace and non-violence, human survival and well-being), through Section 3 (*The child's health and well-being*), Section 4 (*Education, recreational and cultural activities*).
- **Law 202/2002 regarding the equality of opportunities between women and men**, with the subsequent amendments and completions (2018), includes aspects regarding the themes of diversity, tolerance, human rights education, peace and non-violence, gender equality among women and men, including direct reference to ensuring gender equality in education.
- **Government Decision no. 313/2017 regarding the establishment, organisation and functioning of the Department for Sustainable Development**, under the direct supervision of the Prime-Minister. The Department's functions are: to coordinate the activities of implementing the 17 SDGs of the 2030 Agenda; planning and integrating data and information provided by institutions, according to their competencies, in order to promote efficient reporting, coordination and prioritisation of targets and specific goals; monitoring the indicators of sustainable development established at the level of the EU (Eurostat) and at the UN level (StatCom), as well as identifying new necessary indicators. The Department ensures the coordination and representation among the national and local authorities regarding the implementation of 2030 Agenda.
- **Government Decision no. 877/2018 regarding the approval of National Strategy for the Sustainable Development of Romania 2030** based on the 17 Sustainable Development Goals. The Strategy includes a dedicated section on ESD as a form of education that should become an integral part of all quality education and inherent to the concept of lifelong learning. The Strategy also contains several national targets related to ESD, such as: "Ensure that all pupils acquire the necessary skills and knowledge to be able to promote sustainable development, including through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights and gender equality, to promote a culture of peace and non-violence, and to appreciate cultural diversity and the contribution of culture to sustainable development", "Expand the concept of sustainable development in formal university education as a principle and a specialisation, and highlight the role of interdisciplinary research in the development of a sustainable society", "Popularise and promote sustainable models of production and consumption through information campaigns aimed at a broad public and introduce these good practices into school and out-of-school educational curriculum", and "Transition from the current economic model based on production and consumption to a circular economy by changing mentalities through education, changing consumer behaviour and developing financial mechanisms to facilitate the transition period".
- **Government Decision no. 272/2019 regarding the establishment of the Interdepartmental Committee for Sustainable Development**, which is an interinstitutional organism, with consultative role focusing on implementing, monitoring, assessing and revising

the *National Strategy for the Sustainable Development of Romania 2030*. Among its main attributions are: integrating the principles and goals regarding sustainable development in all national policies, programmes, plans and strategies; approving the action plan for the implementation of the Strategy; coordinating the process for elaborating national indicators for sustainable development; analysing the aspects regarding the policy evolution in the field of sustainable development in the European Union and at the international level and the proposal of actions to be implemented by competent authorities.

- ***Order of the Minister of Education and Research no. 5633/2019 regarding the approval of the Methodology for monitoring school segregation in pre-university education*** includes provisions for monitoring segregation in educational environment, through a set of national level indicators, applicable for all levels of education. Segregation is defined in relation with the following criteria: ethnicity, disability or special educational needs, socio-economic status of the family, residence area, level of school performance. The Order provides for the establishment of a National Commission for Desegregation and Educational Inclusion. The themes addressed through the document are: cultural diversity and tolerance; gender equality education; human rights education; peace and non-violence.
- ***Government Decision no. 640/2017 regarding the approval of Programme for schools of Romania during the period 2017-2023 and for establishing the budget for its implementation in the school year 2017-2018***, amended and completed by Government Decision no. 52/2019. The document states the ensuring of free fresh fruits and vegetables and dairy products for children/pupils in pre-school, primary and lower secondary schools. Additionally, the Decision includes educational measures which are to accompany the distribution of fruits, vegetables, milk and dairy products: organising visits to units with activities in this field and/or fairs/exhibitions/harvest festivals (production units or units for conditioning, packaging, storing and processing fruits and vegetables, units for milk processing, research stations in the field etc.); organising thematic competitions related to fruits and vegetable, milk and dairy products and/or honey consumption, as well as organising gardening activities in schools; organizing thematic days, practical educational activities, other extracurricular and out-of-school activities or addressing specific topics within the national curriculum, including through the curriculum at school's decision, within the subject of Education for health. This Government Decision addresses directly and indirectly through its proposed actions themes of GCED and ESD, such as environmental sustainability, human survival and well-being and sustainable consumption and production.
- ***Minister Order no. 5.341/2011 regarding the approval of the Methodology for organizing the National Programme "School After School" (Școala după școală)***, amended and completed by Minister Order no. 4.802/2017. The Programme is a complementary program to the compulsory school courses, which offers opportunities for formal and non-formal learning, for the consolidation of competencies, remedial learning and acceleration of learning through educational, recreational and leisure activities and is aimed at students within primary and secondary education. Each school, depending on the target group, develop and apply modules of activity packages, including so called training for life activity packages, consisting of: self-knowledge activities, activities aimed at developing active attitude, integration and social involvement (codes of conduct, active citizenship, responsible attitude towards the environment, sustainable development etc.), activities for developing communication and critical thinking skills, activities to promote a healthy lifestyle (healthy eating, healthy lifestyle, etc.), activities to prevent risky behaviors due to alcohol, tobacco and drugs, etc.; physical activity and movement. The list of activities is not restricted, schools are allowed to improve it. Thus, the program promote explicitly some of the themes of global citizenship education and ESD (*Cultural diversity and tolerance, Environmental sustainability*), other themes are inferred.
- ***Minister Order no. 5.034/29.08.2016 regarding the approval of the Methodology for organizing the National Programme "School in a different way" (Școala altfel)***. The Programme has continued to be implemented in the reference period 2017 - 2020, on the

basis of Minister Order provisions regarding school year structure annually approved. It is aiming to contribute to the development of learning competence and *socio-emotional skills* of the pre-school, primary and secondary school students, including of those within VET, by non-formal and informal education. Among the targeted socio-emotional skills we mention the following development areas: social skills (understanding the other's perspective, empathizing with people from different cultures, understanding social, civic, community and ethical norms, valuing the resources and support of the family, school and community), relationship skills (the ability to establish and maintain healthy and satisfying relationships with individuals and groups, including the skills of clear communication, active listening, and asking for and providing support), the ability to make decisions in a responsible way (the ability to make personal choices and social interactions based on ethical, safety, social standards, as well as realistically assessing the consequences of various actions on personal well-being, others and the environment). The program is compulsory for children and students, it lasts five days and can be carried out based on plans decided upon by each kindergarten or school, based on the annual curriculum. By this program GCED/ ESD themes Cultural diversity and tolerance, Gender equality education, Human rights education, Peace and non-violence, Human survival and well-being are promoted.

- **Minister Order no. 4.343/ 27.05.2020 regarding the approval of the Methodological Norms (rules) for the application of the provisions of Law on National Education on psychological violence – bullying**, which to promote activities to prevent and combat all forms of bullying and cyberbullying in the pre-university education system. These provisions, as latest developments within national policy which promote the key term Peace and non-violence, are completing the legal framework being also in place: the **Strategy on reducing the phenomenon of violence in pre-university education units, approved by Minister Order no. 1409/29.06.2007**; the **Protocol of cooperation on preventing and combating juvenile delinquency within schools area**, signed by the MoER and the Ministry of Internal Affairs, no. 32104/20.02.2013; **Joint National Action Plan (NAPP) to increase the safety of students and teachers and prevent juvenile delinquency within schools area**, designed and approved by the MoER, the Ministry of Internal Affairs and the Ministry of Regional Development and Public Administration, no. 560 MCA/13.07.2016. **Minister Order no. 5567/2011 for approving the Regulation on the organization and functioning of the units that offer extracurricular activity**, amended and completed by Minister Order no, 4324/2015, sets out the rules for the institutions providing nonformal education, which can also addresses themes of GCED and ESD through its activities.
- **Minister Order no. 4121/2016 regarding the approval of the Vocational Training Standards, Minister Order no. 4457/2016, Minister Order no. 3915/2017 and Minister Order no. 3501/2018 regarding the approval of the curriculum for Vocational Education and Training, grades 9th-12th, and Minister Order no. 3914/2017 regarding the approval of the Local Development Curriculum** – include GCED and ESD themes in the curriculum for VET, as described in sections B, D and F of this survey.
- **Minister Order no. 3393/2017 regarding the approval of the curriculum for lower secondary education** – include the GCED and ESD themes in the curriculum for lower secondary education, as described in section B and D of this survey.
- **Government Emergency Ordinance no. 195/2005 on environmental protection** states, at art. 85, para a), the adaptation of education plans and curriculum at all levels in order to acquire the notions and principles of environmental protection, awareness, training and education in this field. The document addressed directly and indirectly themes of GCED and ESD, such as environmental sustainability and sustainable consumption and production.

A1b. Please provide the full names of any laws, legislation or legal frameworks referred to in A1a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

1. **The Constitution of Romania** (2003) – <https://www.constitutia.ro/>
2. **The Law on National Education no. 1/2011**, with the subsequent amendments and completions – <https://www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/fi%C8%99iere/Legislatie/2019/Legea%20nr%201%20Educatiei%20Nationale%20actualizata%202019.pdf>
3. **Government Ordinance no. 137/2000 regarding the prevention and sanctioning of all forms of discrimination**, with the subsequent amendments and completions (2014) – <http://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/24129>
4. **Law 272/2004 regarding the protection and promotion of child's rights**, with the subsequent amendments and completions (2014) – <http://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/156097>
5. **Law 202/2002 regarding the equality of opportunities between women and men**, with the subsequent amendments and completions (2018) – <https://anes.gov.ro/wp-content/uploads/2018/07/178-mod-202.pdf>
6. **Government Decision no. 313/2017 regarding the establishment, organisation and functioning of the Department for Sustainable Development** – <https://lege5.ro/Gratuit/ge3danjsqa4a/hotararea-nr-313-2017-privind-infiintarea-organizarea-si-functionarea-departamentului-pentru-dezvoltare-durabila>
7. **Government Decision no. 877/2018 regarding the approval of National Strategy for the Sustainable Development of Romania 2030** – http://www.asrm.ro/pdf/noutati/noutati-legislative-noiembrie-2018/Hotararea_877_2018_Strategie_dezvoltare_durabila_Romania.pdf; Annex 1 of the Strategy anexa 1 (Strategia 2030) - <https://sgg.gov.ro/new/wp-content/uploads/2018/11/ANEXA-SNDDR-2030.pdf>
8. **Government Decision no. 272/2019 regarding the establishment of the Interdepartmental Committee for Sustainable Development** – <https://lege5.ro/Gratuit/gmztcnjsqmya/hotararea-nr-272-2019-privind-constituirea-comitetului-interdepartamental-pentru-dezvoltare-durabila>
9. **Order of the Minister of Education and Research no. 5633/2019 regarding the approval of the Methodology for monitoring school segregation in pre-university education** – <http://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocumentAfis/221840>
10. **Government Decision no. 640/2017 regarding the approval of Programme for schools of Romania during the period 2017-2023 and for establishing the budget for its implementation in the school year 2017-2018**, amended and completed by Government Decision no. 52/2019 – <http://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/193180>; <http://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocumentAfis/210613#A350>
11. **Minister Order no. 5.341/2011 regarding the approval of the Methodology for organizing the National Programme "School After School" (Școala după școală)**,

amended and completed by Minister Order no. 4.802/2017 – https://aicta.ro/site/downloads/ghidelev/SDS_ordin_modificare_metodologie_2017.pdf.

12. **Minister Order no. 5.034/29.08.2016 regarding the approval of the Methodology for organizing the National Programme “School in a different way” (Școala altfel)** – <https://www.edu.ro/etichete/%C5%9Fcoala-altfel>.
13. **Minister Order no. 4.343/ 27.05.2020 regarding the approval of the Methodological Norms (rules) for the application of the provisions of Law on National Education on psychological violence – bullying** – https://www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/ fi%C8%99iere/LeGislatie/2020/OMEC_4343_2020_norme%20antibullying.pdf.
14. **Minister Order no. 5567/2011 for approving the Regulation on the organization and functioning of the units that offer extracurricular activity** – https://www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/ fi%C8%99iere/Invatamant-Preuniversitar/2016/nonformal/ORDIN%204624_2015_modif_anexa1_Reg_unit_care_ofera_activit_extrascolara.PDF.
15. **Minister Order no. 4121/2016 regarding the approval of the Vocational Training Standards, Minister Order no. 4457/2016, Minister Order no. 3915/2017 and Minister Order no. 3501/2018 regarding the approval of the curriculum for Vocational Education and Training, grades 9th-12th, and Minister Order no. 3914/2017 regarding the approval of the Local Development Curriculum** – <https://www.edu.ro/planuri-de-%C3%AEenv%C4%83%C8%9B%C4%83m%C3%A2nt-%C8%99i-programe-%C8%99colare-%C3%AEenv%C4%83%C8%9B%C4%83m%C3%A2nt-profesional>.
16. **Minister Order no. 3393/2017 regarding the approval of the curriculum for lower secondary education** – https://www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/OMEN%203393_Programe%20Scolare%20Gimnaziu.pdf
17. **Government Emergency Ordinance no. 195/2005 on environmental protection** – <http://legislatie.just.ro/Public/DetaliuDocument/67634>.

*A2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal frameworks on education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	National				Sub-national			
	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1	99	1	1	99
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1	99	1	1	99
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1	99	1	1	99
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1	99	1	1	99
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1	99	1	1	99

6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1	99	1	1	99
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1	99	1	1	99
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1	99	1	1	99

A3a. Please describe any specific current national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives in your country that promote global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes² are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

Complementing the legal framework, the policies and strategies adopted in the field of education address specific topics related to GCED and ESD in terms of content, as well as the principles governing the national education system.

Policy documents directly related to the national education system

- ***National Strategy for the Reduction of Early School Leaving*** ensures the coordination of all national policies in the area and combines a series of prevention, intervention and compensation measures, focused on school and pupil level interventions. Through its assumed targets, the Strategy focuses on fostering access to education and the provision of quality education to all children by developing and consolidating the early childhood education and care system; ensuring that all children complete compulsory education with the support of early warning and intervention mechanisms; the reintegration in the educational system of the early school leavers by means of quality specially tailored programmes (Second Chance programmes); the development and the provision of adequate institutional support. The Strategy contributes to ensuring the right to quality education for each child, having long-term social and economic implications, with effects on smart growth (improving education and training levels), and inclusive growth (highlighting early school leaving as a risk factor for unemployment, poverty and social exclusion). The Strategy targets GCED and ESD themes of human survival and well-being, as well as sustainable consumption and production.

² See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

- **Strategy on vocational education and training in Romania for the period of 2016-2020** focuses on the initial and continual professional training as accessible, attractive, competitive and relevant factors for the labour market needs. The Strategy, completed by the other strategic framework, proposes a global vision on the development / consolidation of the entire vocational education and training system for lifelong learning participants. At the same time, from the perspective of qualifications and competencies, this strategy includes an approach related to the strategies developed by the Ministry of Labor, Social Protection, Family and the Elderly in the field of employment and social equity. Part of the targets of this strategy indirectly support the development of some areas subsumed to GCED and ESD: increasing the employment rate of population aged between 20-64 years old; the reduction of greenhouse gas emissions; increasing the rate of renewable energy; increasing energy efficiency.
- **National Strategy for Lifelong Learning 2015-2020** aims at enhancing adults' participation in lifelong learning activities and supports the accomplishment of European and national key goals, such as smart, inclusive and sustainable growth. The Strategy includes strategic pillars comprised of coordinating, financing and regulating activities for stimulating the participation to lifelong learning, with effects on human well-being, sustainable production etc.
- **National Strategy for Tertiary Education 2015-2020** supports the essential role of tertiary education for the individual and society's progress, for developing highly qualified human capital in order to ensure the labour market growth and economic growth, all of them with broader effects on human survival and well-being, sustainable consumption and production, as well as environmental sustainability. This strategy correlates with other strategies for research, development - innovation and lifelong learning, as all three fields promote tertiary sector as the engine of economic growth based on knowledge and highly qualification. The main areas of intervention in higher education focus on: encouraging and supporting wider participation in tertiary education, especially of underrepresented group, improving the quality and relevance of tertiary education, supporting flexible study programs, and a strategic engagement towards the economic sector.

All the above mentioned Strategies were approved through Government Decisions and include Action Plans for the implementation of the proposed goals, through specific targets.

- **Educated Romania** is a vision and strategic document for the period 2018-2030, developed under auspices of the President of Romania. Based on present needs of the society and anticipating future needs, the Strategy proposes a new architecture of the Romanian educational system, based on three pillars: personalisation and ensuring quality in the educational process; raising the flexibility of the educational system; the adaptability of educational system to the external changes and the future trends. The document formulates 12 goals, among which: training active citizens, with European values, adapted to the economic and social needs, with a solid civic and democratic culture; individualising education by ensuring conditions for developing children's and students' potential; ensuring an equitable and quality educational system in terms of access, participation and completion; respect for ethics and integrity through behaviours, norms and curriculum benchmarks. The document addresses all themes of GCED and ESD.

Policy documents indirectly related to education, relevant to the realisation of GCED and ESD and to whose implementation the MoER contributes

- **The National Reform Programme (2017–2020)** is the framework platform for defining the development priorities guiding Romania's development until 2020, in order to achieve Europe 2020 Strategy objectives and for defining structural reforms to meet the challenges identified by the EC for Romania. Although the title of the document points to reforms, its substance is more a report on on-going and planned projects aimed at achievement of

specific objectives within defined priorities. The document addresses all themes of GCED and ESD through measures supporting the educational system as a whole.

- ***National Strategy “A society without barriers for persons with disabilities” 2015-2020*** focuses on promoting, protecting and ensuring the full exercise and in equal conditions of fundamental human rights and freedoms for persons with disabilities. The main lines of action address accessibility, participation, equality, employment, education and VET, social protection, health, as well as statistics and data collection. The document addresses several themes of GCED and ESD, such as human rights education, peace and non-violence.
- ***National Strategy for the protection and promotion of the rights of the child 2014-2020*** includes a series of specific goals focusing on developing services for preventing the separation of the child from the family and the prevention and combating of any forms of violence. Among the measures envisioned we mention: increasing the level of knowledge and awareness among children, parents, professionals and general population regarding all forms of violence; reducing the exposure of children to violence in mass-media and online environment; capacity building for public services providers regarding the prevention and combating of any forms of violence against children. The Strategy addresses several themes of GCED and ESD: human rights education, peace and non-violence, human survival and well-being.
- ***National Strategy for the promotion of equal opportunities and treatment between women and men and preventing and combating domestic violence for the period 2018-2020*** supports the promotion of several measures for educating young generation, for balancing professional and personal life, encouraging women’s participation in decision making. In the field of education, the interventions focus on raising the level of awareness of children and youth regarding the legal provisions in terms of equal opportunities between women and men, as well as combating gender based stereotypes among youth. The Strategy addresses several themes of GCED and ESD: gender equality education, human rights education, peace and non-violence, human survival and well-being.
- ***National Strategy for the inclusion of Romanian citizens belonging to Roma minority for the period 2014-2020*** supports the socio-economic inclusion of Romanian citizens belonging to Roma minority to a level similar to that of the rest of the population. The activities proposed, with a focus on global education, cultural diversity and tolerance, include the following goals: increasing the access to education through programs, actions and provision of services of information, mediation, consulting and assisting, as well as through assessing and certifying competences etc.
- ***National Strategy for social inclusion and poverty reduction for the period 2015-2020*** proposes measures for ensuring equal opportunities of participation in society, appreciation and valuing, of respecting human dignity, realisation of basic needs and respect for differences. In order to realise the goal of the Romanian Government, the Strategy includes activities addressing several themes of GCED and ESD: cultural diversity and tolerance, gender equality education, human rights education, peace and non-violence and human survival and well-being.
- ***National Strategy for Competitiveness 2015-2020*** focuses on correlating the interventions aimed at increasing competitiveness, considering the national areas of excellence from multiple perspective, including from the development of human capital perspective. Among the priority areas of intervention, such as social inclusion and poverty reduction, VET as basis for ensuring human rights and economic competitiveness, the Strategy addresses GCED and ESD (human survival and well-being, sustainable consumption and production, human rights education).

- The key term *Climate change education* is explicitly promoted by the National Action Plan for the implementation of the ***National Strategy on Climate Change and economic growth based on low-carbon emissions for the period 2016-2020*** under the strategic objective “Improving the education of citizens on reducing gas emissions with greenhouse effect and on adaptation to climate change”. The strategy and the action plan were initiated by the Ministry of Environment, Waters and Forests.
- According to the provisions of the **National Waste Generation Prevention Programme**, included in the ***National Waste Management Plan, approved by Government Decision no. 942/20.12.2017***, one of the measures to be implemented is “*educating the young generation on environmental protection, in general and on the prevention of household waste generation, in particular*”. The measure is aiming changes in attitudes and behaviors and eco-skills development of the students within pre-university education, by formal and non- formal education. *Environmental sustainability, Sustainable consumption and production* and *Climate change education* are the related key terms. The Ministry of Environment, Waters and Forests initiated and coordinates the implementation of the national programme and the plan.
- ***National Strategy for Digital Agenda for Romania 2020*** focuses on supporting the economic recovery of Europe and, in particular, sustainable, smart and inclusive economic growth. The Strategy highlights 5 European goals: employment (75% of persons aged 20-64 to be employed), research and development (allocating 3% of GDP); climate change and energy sustainability; education (at least 40% of persons aged 30-34 to complete ISCED 3); combating poverty and social exclusion.

A3b. Please provide the full names of any education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives referred to in A3a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

- **National Strategy for the Reduction of Early School Leaving** – <https://www.edu.ro/strategii-condi%C8%9Bionalit%C4%83%C8%9Bi-ex-ante;>
- **Strategy on vocational education and training in Romania for the period of 2016-2020** – <https://www.edu.ro/strategii-condi%C8%9Bionalit%C4%83%C8%9Bi-ex-ante;>
- **National Strategy for Lifelong Learning 2015-2020** – <https://www.edu.ro/strategii-condi%C8%9Bionalit%C4%83%C8%9Bi-ex-ante;>
- **National Strategy for Tertiary Education 2015-2020** – <https://www.edu.ro/strategii-condi%C8%9Bionalit%C4%83%C8%9Bi-ex-ante;>
- **Educated Romania** – [http://www.romaniaeducata.eu/;](http://www.romaniaeducata.eu/)
- **National Strategy “A society without barriers for persons with disabilities” 2015-2020** – http://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/images/Documente/Proiecte_in_dezbatere/2015/2015-10-08-proiecthg-strateg-diz-anexa1.pdf;
- **National Strategy for the protection and promotion of the rights of the child 2014-2020** – [http://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/images/Documente/Transparenta/2014/2014-02-03 Anexa1 HG Strategie protectia copilului.pdf;](http://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/images/Documente/Transparenta/2014/2014-02-03_Anexa1_HG_Strategie_protectia_copilului.pdf;)
- **National Strategy for the promotion of equal opportunities and treatment between women and men and preventing and combating domestic violence for the period 2018-2020** – <https://anes.gov.ro/wp-content/uploads/2018/06/Strategia-Nationala-ES-si-VD.pdf;>
- **National Strategy for the inclusion of Romanian citizens belonging to Roma minority for the period 2014-2020** – http://www.anr.gov.ro/docs/Site2014/Strategie/Strategie_final_18-11-2014.pdf;
- **National Strategy for social inclusion and poverty reduction for the period 2015-2020** – <http://www.mmuncii.ro/j33/index.php/ro/2014-domenii/familie/politici-familiale-incluziune-si-asistenta-sociala/3916;>
- **National Strategy for Competitivity 2015-2020** – <https://lege5.ro/Gratuit/haydambyga/strategia-nationala-pentru-competitivitate-2015-2020-septembrie-2015-hotarare-775-2015?dp=haztmmjugmzdo;>
- **The National waste management plan**, approved by Government Decision no. 942/2017, http://www.mmediu.ro/app/webroot/uploads/files/2018-01-10_MO_11_bis.pdf
- **The National Strategy on climate change and economic growth based on low-carbon emissions for the period 2016-2020**, approved by Government Decision no. 739/2016, <http://mmediu.ro/cateorie/strategia-nationala-privind-schimbarile-climatice-rezumat/171>.
- **National Strategy for Digital Agenda for Romania 2020** – https://www.ancom.ro/uploads/links_files/Strategia_nationala_privind_Agenda_Digitala_pe_ntru_Romania_2020.pdf.

*A4. Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives affecting each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*A5 Please indicate whether national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives on education provide a mandate to integrate GCED and ESD in the following areas by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
Design or revision of the curriculum	1	1	1	1
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	1	1
Textbook development	1	1	1	99
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	1
Assessment of student outcomes	1	1	1	1
Sub-national				
Design or revision of the curriculum	1	1	1	1
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	1	1
Textbook development	99	99	0	99
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	1
Assessment of student outcomes	1	1	9	1

B. Curriculum (paras 4 and 10-19 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

B1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in school curriculum. Indicate whether topics are taught as standalone subjects or are integrated into the curriculum of other subjects. Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes³ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

GCED and ESD are integrated into the formal education system mainly through the optional curriculum, civic education and extra-curriculum activities. In addition, GCED and ESD are mainstreamed into several subjects of compulsory curriculum (e.g., “mathematics and environmental exploration” of primary education and “mathematics and natural science”-related subjects of secondary education) and, at the initiative of individual teachers, in other subjects of compulsory curriculum.

- **Early education**, consisting of pre-preschool (0–3-year-olds) and preschool (3–6-year-olds) levels, is optional in Romania. The new curriculum for early education adopted in August 2019 (www.edu.ro/sites/default/files/Curriculum%20ET_2019_aug.pdf) stipulates that EE activities are free-choice activities and can be integrated into several other activities, such as in personal development activities and experiential field activities, depending on the type and theme of these activities and how well they correlate with the theme of the project or with the weekly theme. The field of cognitive development and knowledge of the world – one of five development fields in the curriculum structure – can integrate ESD as well.
- **Primary education** is mandatory in Romania and takes place for five years starting with the preparatory grade and ending with grade four (for 6/7–10-year-old children). Primary school education integrates environmental and sustainable development related themes in several mandatory and optional subjects, through specific topics in the curriculum, as well as through the activities which address the development of specific skills, attitudes and behaviours in participating pupils.
- **Lower secondary education** is mandatory in Romania and lasts five years from grades five to eight (for 11–14-year-old children). ESD and GCED are integrated into various subjects of the mandatory curriculum and is included among subjects of the optional curriculum chosen by the school (in consultation with parents through a Parents' Committee). The curriculum includes ESD and GCED related themes through specific topics, as well as through the activities which address the development of specific skills, attitudes and behaviours in participating pupils.
- The national curriculum for **VET pre-university education**, offered at national level, is approved by order of the Minister of Education. There is no specific discipline or modules for ESD. The key themes of GCED and ESD are included/ integrated in disciplines in core curriculum, in technical curriculum or optional curriculum. Some of these topics are also addressed in Counseling and career guidance. In Romania qualifications are described through Training Standards, containing a number of Learning Outcomes Unites in terms of knowledge, skills and attitudes, which also reflect the GCED and ESD elements either through specific training of specialists, or through the development of attitudes and behaviours part of GCED and ESD. Furthermore, entrepreneurial skills are developed by an interactive learning method - the method of training firms. The Local Development Curriculum (CDL) is a component of the National Curriculum, which is the curriculum offer specific to each VET school and is carried out in partnership with companies. This type of curriculum provides the necessary framework for the adaptation of the students' professional training to the requirements of the local and regional labor market, thus promoting a whole community approach. Designing the Local Development Curriculum

³ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

involves teachers and tutors in developing the content, the learning situations for students and the assessments methods and tools.

- In terms of **higher education**, universities are autonomous, with the assumption of public responsibility expressed in the university charter, equity and university ethics policies included in the Code of Professional Ethics and Deontology. The inclusion of GCED and ESD themes is addressed through specific study programmes in the fields of GCED and ESD, as well as through specific activities promoting the entrepreneurial skills of students (eg support Student Entrepreneurial Societies) or volunteering activities in these specific fields. The higher education institutions are mandated to prevent violence, discrimination and bullying on any ground within their educational spaces, thus promoting the GCED and ESD principles from a broader perspective.

B1b. Please provide examples of curriculum in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

GCED and ESD are an important part of the national training profile of the graduate of secondary education (available here: http://www.ise.ro/wp-content/uploads/2015/12/Profilul-de-formare-al-absolventului_final.pdf), being included in the national curriculum for primary and secondary education (available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/PI_cadru-actuale/Primar/1_OMEN_3.371_12.03.2%2013%20%20privind%20aprobarea%20planurilor-cadru%20inv_primar%20si%20a%20Metodologiei%20privind%20aplicarea%20planurilor-cadru%20de%20invatamant.pdf).

Examples of subjects which include themes referring to GCED and ESD:

GCED and ESD are included in the curriculum for **preschool education**, through the topic: Who am I / Who are we? When / how and why does it happen?
http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Pre/TT/Curriculum%20pentru%20invatamantul%20prescolar%203%20%E2%80%93%206-7%20ani.pdf

1. GCED as a standalone topic in specific subjects:

- **Civic education** for primary education:
 - 3rd grade – 3 topics: *Our relations with things/ animals and plants /the others*;
 - 4th grade – 1 topic: *Universal children's rights* (available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2014-12/25-Educatie%20civica_clasele%20a%20III-a%20-%20a%20IV-a.pdf);
- **Civic education** for lower secondary education: 7th grade – 1 topic *Life in society* (the curriculum was used until 2018 and in 2020 they were replaced, the curriculum is available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Gim/OS/Cultura%20civica_clasele%20a%20VII-a%20-%20a%20VIII-a.pdf);
- **Social education**, lower secondary level (available here: <http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2017-progr/28-Educatie%20sociala.pdf>):
 - 5th grade – subject *Critical thinking and child's rights*;
 - 6th grade – subject *Intercultural education*: trains pupils for intercultural dialogue through topics such as: *Multicultural society and intercultural society; Principles and values of the intercultural society; The person and the intercultural society; Intercultural education as dialogue of cultures*. The curriculum focuses on participation and aims at improving the intercultural dialogue and at promoting actions for this;
 - 7th grade – optional subject *Education for democratic citizenship*: includes topics such as: human rights, forms of government and political regimes, citizen-authority relation, active citizenship;

- 8th grade – subject *Economic and financial education*.

2. GCED included in school curriculum for other subjects through skills and knowledge taught or attitudes and behaviours instilled:

- **History** (mandatory subject, part of the common core):
 - Primary level, 4th grade – general competencies: *Forming a positive image about self and the others* (available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2014-12/23-Istorie_clasa%20a%20IV-a.pdf);
 - Lower secondary level, 5th – 8th grades – general competencies: *Manifesting civic behaviour through the use of historical experience and socio-cultural diversity*. Relevant topics: *Illuminism – reason, rights, people's involvement in public life; Public opinion in the 18th century; Woman in public life; Citizen and state in democracy and totalitarianism; The world between the 2 World Wars: Daily life – city organisation, rural world, inventions and domestic life, entertainment, people's health, culture; The post-war world: Daily life – from war's drama to prosperity; Contemporary world: a multipolar world – globalization; new cultural diversity and informational revolution* (available here: <http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2017-progr/29-Istorie.pdf>);
 - Upper secondary level, 9th – 10th grades – general competencies: *Developing civic behaviour through the exercise of social abilities; Forming a positive image about self and the others*. Relevant topics: *Society at the beginning of the 3rd millennium: globalisation, terrorism, daily life; The post-war world: human rights, minorities, the role of civil society; Religion in the contemporary world; The big conflicts of the 20th century; The post-war international relations* (available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/OS/Istorie_clasa%20a%20IX-a.pdf; http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/OS/Istorie_clasa%20a%20X-a.pdf);
 - Upper secondary level, 11th – 12th grades: general competencies: *Excercising the civic and democratic approaches and actions*. Relevant topics: *Cooperation and conflict: institutions, mechanisms and policies to solve conflicts in the contemporary world; Economy and society in the post-war world: occupations and professional status; Migrants in contemporary world; Private life and public life; Economic theories and ideas: driven economy and liberal economy*. (available at: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/OS/Istorie_clasa%20a%20XI-a%20XII-a.pdf).
- The curriculum for **mother tongue** and **modern languages** in primary and secondary education take into account the model of communication skills, which also integrates sociocultural and intercultural components, in the context of cultural diversity as promoted by GCED. At the lower secondary level, in order to form intercultural behaviors and develop the interest for students' cultural diversity, both the curriculum for *Romanian language and literature* and those for *Mother tongue and literature* (14 national minorities) explicitly provide a general competence that aims to show interest in cultural diversity; intercultural behaviors; expressing one's own linguistic and cultural identity in a national and international context. The specific subjects where elements of GCED are addressed are: *Modern languages* such as Language 1 or Language 2 (French, English, German, Italian, Turkish, Spanish, Chinese, Russian, Japanese); *Communication in Romanian for schools and sections with teaching in the language of national minorities; Romanian language and literature for schools and sections with teaching in the language of national minorities; Communication in Romanian; Romanian Language and Literature; Mother tongue and literature* (curriculum available here: <http://programe.ise.ro/Actuale/Programeinvigoare.aspx>).
- **Personal development**, primary level, preparatory grade, 1st and 2nd grade, proposed topics: *Me and others, Diversity (about individual differences); interactions with beings and objects in familiar situations* (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/2013_CP_I_II/55_Dezvoltare%20personala_CP_II_OMEN.pdf);

- **Counseling and personal development**, lower secondary level, 5th grade: Self-knowledge and healthy and balanced lifestyle; Lifestyle quality; Self-knowledge and personal development (curriculum available here: <http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2017-progr/118-Consiliere%20si%20dezvoltare%20personala.pdf>);
- **Education for society** (optional subject), primary level, grades 0 – 2: focuses on civic and moral behaviors versus behaviors lacking civic and moral values, as well as membership groups (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Aug/Educatie%20pentru%20societate-p-1-2.pdf);
- **Ready for life** (optional subject), primary level, grades 0 – 2: includes topics such as: People's responsibility towards nature; Norms of behavior in current life contexts (family, school); Care for the environment – importance and ways of manifestation, Nature - a whole of interdependent parts. Hypostases of the natural and social environment; Emotions (Frustration and Self-Control, Compassion, Empathy, Caring for others etc.), Gender stereotypes, Rights and respect for difference, Famous women and men in history, culture, other fields, examples from everyday life, Diversity. Unity in diversity, Respect for each person's potential, Accepting the other: managing one's own and others' mistakes, appreciating the success of others, Authority and initiative (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2018-progr/PRIM/Pregatiti%20pentru%20viata_Clasale%200-IV_opt.pdf);
- **Health education** (optional subject), primary and secondary levels, include topics related social relations (gender differences), my rights and those of colleagues; (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Pri/CD/Educatie%20pentru%20sanatate_clasale%20I%20-%20a%20XII-a.pdf);
- **Migration in the contemporary world** (optional subject), upper secondary level, focuses on specific skills related to GCED, such as: Advancing views on the causes that have determined contemporary migration; Anticipating the evolution of migrations in the 21st century; Investigating the way in which the Romanian society reacts to the challenges of migration; Formulation of coherent and reasoned opinions about the values (material and cultural) that migrants bring from their countries of origin. Relevant topics addressed: Types of migrations; Migrations and country of origin; Migrations and destination country. (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/CD/OS/Migratii%20contemporane-secolele%20XX%20si%20XXI_clasale%20a%20XI-a_%20a%20XII-a.pdf).

3. ESD included in school curriculum for subjects through skills and knowledge taught or attitudes and behaviours instilled:

- **Biology** (mandatory subject):
 - Lower secondary level: 5th grade, addresses through topics such as: the place of humans and their impact on the environment, cultivated plant care, domesticated and pet animals, prevention of infestations / infections with parasites from the immediate environment and environmental degradation; 8th grade: Human health and environmental health (curriculum available here <http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2017-progr/27-Biologie.pdf>);
 - Upper secondary level: 9th grade, the topic of Genetic engineering and biotechnology (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/MS/Biologie_clasa%20a%20IX-a.pdf); 10th grade, the topic of Ecological imbalances: causes, effects, measures (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/MS/Biologie_clasa%20a%20X-a.pdf);
 - Vocational education and training: 9th grade the topic of Biodiversity conservation in Romania: protected species, nature reserves, national parks (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2014-progr/profesionala/MS/Biologie_clasa%20a%20IX-a.pdf).

- **Geography** (mandatory subject), taught at primary and secondary levels, for example in upper secondary levels, grades 9-10, it addresses topics such as: environment, landscape and human society, Geography of human settlements; Economic geography – resources (curriculum available here: <http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2014-12/24-Geografie%20-%20clasa%20a%20IV-a.pdf>; http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Gim/OS/Geografie_clasele%20a%20V-a%20-%20a%20VIII-a.pdf; http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/OS/Geografie_clasa%20a%20IX-a.pdf; http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/OS/Geografie_clasa%20a%20X-a.pdf);
- **Technological education and practical applications** (mandatory subject), lower secondary level, focuses on topics such as: Applied technologies in agriculture, gastronomy; Quality, economy and entrepreneurship, Quality of food products (organoleptic properties, nutritional value, energy and aesthetics) and food services; Consumer protection - Hygiene rules in animal husbandry and food preparation. Promotion and capitalization of vegetable, animal, food production; Sustainable development (healthy lifestyle, clean environment, influence on the individual / society) (curriculum available here: <http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/2017-progr/116-Educatie%20tehnologica%20si%20aplicatii%20%20practice.pdf>);
- **Ecological education and environmental protection** (optional subject), primary and lower secondary education, with themes of sustainable development (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Pri/CD/Educatie%20ecologica%20si%20de%20protectie%20%20mediului%20prescolar_primar_gimnazial.pdf);
- **Intercultural education** (part of the curriculum decided at the level school), upper secondary level, includes topics such as: Social diversity and the culture of diversity, Education for interculturality: Let's learn to live together, The intercultural educational project (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/CD/OS/education%20interculturala_CDS%20programa%20liceu.pdf);
- **Education for democracy** (part of the curriculum decided at the level school), upper secondary level, includes topics such as: I, the citizen, Democracy in school, School-community partnership, legal education, Institutions at the service of the citizen (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/CD/OS/Education%20pentru%20democratie_CDS_programa%20liceu.pdf);
- **EU institutions** (part of the curriculum decided at the level school), upper secondary level, includes topics such as: EU constitution, EU institutions, history and their role (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.ro/Portals/1/Curriculum/Progr_Lic/CD/OS/Institutiile%20Uniunii%20Europene_CDS_programa%20liceu.pdf);
- **Education for Development** (part of the curriculum decided at the level school), upper secondary level, includes: Globalization and its Problems, Global Citizenship and Sustainable Development, Human Rights, Social Justice and Tolerance, Environment and Sustainable Development, Global Partnership for Development, Educational Project for Development (curriculum available here: http://programe.ise.com/Portals/1/curriculum/2015/high/CDS/OS/Education%20pentru%20dezvoltare_liceu.pdf);

GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in the educational process through “**Second Chance**” program, which addresses adolescents, youth, adults coming from diverse social environments and of different ages, who did not enrol or complete primary and lower secondary education. The program offers the possibility of continuing and completing mandatory education for these categories of persons, without determining them to quit or interrupt their professional or familial activities. The subjects taught in this program are the same ones taught regular school and GCED and ESD are included in specific subjects as mentioned above.

In terms of **Vocational Education and Training**, the analysis of the VET qualifications and the curriculum for the VET shows that in the fields of agriculture and environmental protection are identified "green" qualifications, mainstreaming the principles and instruments of ESD, through training for the following qualifications:

- **Worker in organic farming** (EQF level 3) - are skilled workers who organize and carry out agricultural activities for the cultivation and harvesting of agricultural crops, animal husbandry and for the sale or delivery of products to buyers or specialized organizations and markets.
- **Technician in technological agriculture** (EQF level 4) - has specialized technical knowledge on plant cultivation and animal husbandry in ecological conditions, skills for planning and organizing production and work, coordinating activities to control the quality of works and products on farms green.
- **Ecological technician and environmental quality protection** (EQF level 4) - has competences for biodiversity conservation, applying and respecting regulations in force at European and international level regarding sustainable development and care for the environment. It also has the skills to collect water, air, soil samples and perform analyzes of environmental factors. At the same time, it has competencies for monitoring and controlling the quality of drinking water and wastewater, but also of anthropogenic ecosystems, along with waste management competencies. Graduates can work in different economic agents, within the Environmental Protection departments, in the Environmental Protection Agencies, in different parks and protected areas, etc.

It is intended to develop "green" qualifications in the energy field as well as technicians and workers for renewable energy sources.

For the other qualifications, the technical and practical training modules includes topics related to environmental protection, hazardous waste storage, reuse and reconditioning of products (circular economy), efficient use of natural resources, ensuring a sustainable and appropriate environment for harmonious development of citizens.

GCED and ESD topics are also addressed in extracurriculum activities, such as: the "School in a Different Way" project (Scoala Altfel), "Earth Day" project, "Spring school" project, developed at national and local level.

In terms of **higher education**, universities have begun to introduce elements of **sustainable development**, new disciplines in the compulsory or optional curriculum, depending on the study programs. Topics cover climate change, managing the effects of social and economic change, environmental economics, public policy and environmental management, alternative energy, wastewater, pollution reduction, green technologies (in over 240 undergraduate and master's degree programs). In addition to undergraduate programs specific to their fields of study, a large number of universities have introduced master's programs aimed at training in the field of sustainable development. Environment protection and sustainable development themes are integrated to varying degrees in the studies (both compulsory and optional curriculum) depending on the specialization. As at December 2019, over 240 undergraduate and master study programmes included topics such as climate change, social and economic change management, environmental economics, public policy and environmental management, alternative energies, wastewater and green technologies. In addition to bachelor's degree programmes, universities have introduced master programmes related to sustainable development.

Regarding **GCED** elements (cultural diversity and tolerance, gender equality education, human rights education, and peace and non-violence), specifically in social sciences studies at bachelor and masters' level, as well as generally in other study programmes, universities have introduced specific subjects or have developed specific study programmes (bachelor and/or masters) which cover skills, knowledge, attitudes and behaviours promoted by GCED.

***B2** Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

***B3** Please indicate in which subjects or fields of study GCED and ESD are taught in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Cultural diversity and tolerance	Gender equality	Human rights	Peace and non-violence	Climate change	Environmental sustainability	Human survival and well-being	Sustainable consumption and production
Arts	1	1	1	1	0	0	1	0
Civics, civil or citizenship education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Ethics/moral studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Geography	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Health, physical education and sports	1	1	1	1	1	0	1	1
History	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Languages	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Mathematics	0	0	0	0	1	1	1	1
Religious education	1	0	1	1	0	1	1	1
Science	0	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Social studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Integrated studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Other (please specify)								

*B4 Please indicate the approaches used to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	1
Cross-curriculum approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum</i>)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum</i>)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school</i>)	1

B5 Please indicate which human rights education themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
3. Human rights education				
3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status	1	1	1	1
3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation	1	1	1	1
3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)	1	1	1	1

C. Teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) (paras 4 and 33-37 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

C1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in initial training and in continuing professional development of teachers, trainers and educators. Indicate whether all teachers, trainers and educators or only some are required to receive training to teach GCED and/or ESD.

The Departments for Training the Teaching Staff within the **higher education institutions** offer initial and continual training for teachers, in order to provide certification for the teaching profession. The training provides access to teaching methods in line with international and national standards, ensuring the acquisition of specific competencies in order to promote also themes specific to GCED and ESD.

Regarding the initial training of teachers, the study program The didactic master, implemented as a pilot program starting from the academic year 2020 - 2021, introduces a study plan in accordance with the systemic priorities. Relevant mandatory subjects taught are: inclusive education (addresses students with special educational needs, persons belonging to ethnic minorities, refugees etc.), effective communication and emotions' management, virtual learning environments. Optional subjects are: education and community, non-formal education, designing of extracurricular educational activities, intercultural education, education for diversity, education and well-being, counseling and school guidance, remedial pedagogies etc.

For the continuous development of teachers, in accordance with the strategic directions of action, the following topics are considered as priorities: digitalization of the educational system, resilience in the educational environment, reducing school dropout, inclusive education, gifted education etc., in order to update the teachers' competencies. In line with the provisions on preventing psychological violence – bullying, within the programs of continuous training of the teaching staff will be introduced information sessions / topics / training courses on issues related to psychological violence - bullying, in order to acquire skills in identifying them and the ability to apply appropriate educational strategies. VET teachers for technical modules are usually engineers / economists / veterinarians, etc. GCED and ESD are tangentially included in the university curriculum. In terms of continuing profesional development, VET teachers can access training courses addressing GCED and ESD provided by Teacher Training House, Universities or other authorized providers. Teachers are the ones who choose which courses they access but also at the recommendation of the school management. Continuous professional development needs analyses are usually conducted at school level, yearly, by the responsible appointed for teacher training.

In Romania continuous training for teachers is mandatory. Trainings are offered by the Teacher Training Centres which are accredited by MoER, by the universities or other accredited providers. Trainings offered by Teachers Centres, approved annually by MoER, include the organization of courses, seminars and workshops. The training courses accredited by the ministry include topics related to ESD and GCED, such as: education for sustainable development: developing life abilities; education for sustainable development: school-family-community partnership; environmental protection: the main criterion for a sustainable lifestyle; integrating critical thinking in the curriculum; sustainability in the protection of the environment: integral part of the educational process; developing the life skills of pupils in the context of sustainable development; education for democracy; methods of critical thinking; learning strategies for critical thinking; volunteering for the environment: present and perspectives; education for gender equality: strategies for prevention and active intervention in the school environment; and education for the environment: ways of doing it. The choice of these training courses is optional. There is no compulsory training on GCED or ESD for teachers and educational personnel.

C1b. Please provide examples of teacher training policies or curriculum in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents. If possible, include examples related to initial training and to continuing professional development.

For example, the study programme for **training history teachers** through retraining (distance learning) includes the optional subject *Teaching history and civic education*, studied in the 3rd semester. The topic of this subject addresses civic education and GCED at large, through themes such as: *History and civic education – conceptual framework; History and civic education – attitudes perspective; History and civic education – contemporary topics (democratic competencies and values; emigration and immigration; events, trends and agents of change in contemporary world)*. The activities and competencies developed through this subject aim at providing the future teachers with the necessary knowledge, skills, behaviours, attitudes and values in order to promote GCED among students. The study programme can be accessed here: http://hiphi.ubbcluj.ro/studii/Public/File/cursuri/suporturi_conversie/Predarea-istoriei.pdf.

Another example of continual training programme is the course offered by the House of Teaching Staff Bucharest on the topic of **School inclusion management**, which aims at developing transversal skills of teachers in order to prevent exclusion in schools through innovative teaching methods, designing intervention strategies, the use of information technologies etc. The study programme can be accessed here: <http://ccd-bucuresti.org/images/PDF/Cursuri/2019-2020/ACR2019/FISA-IDENTITATE-MIS-ID-20200713.pdf>.

For professional continuing development, we add mention the online course on **Global Education - The Citizenship Dimension** organized by the North-South Center of the Council of Europe, in collaboration with The Network University, 2019 (<https://www.erasmusplus.ro/termen-eurodesk/vrs/IDed/54>), where Romanian teachers could take part.

Noteworthy in terms of mainstreaming GCED and ESD in teacher training is the Project **Relevant curriculum, open education for all** (CRED), an ambitious project launched by the MoER in late 2017 and implemented until 2021. The general project's objective is to prevent the early school leaving by means of systemic measures targeting the innovative and sustainable implementation of the new curriculum, which covers as discussed above the elements pertaining to GCED and ESD. It is to be noted that an important part of the Project is devoted to the training of 55,000 teachers from primary and lower secondary education in order to prepare them to successfully implement the new curricula.

*C2 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach GCED and ESD during initial or pre-service training and/or through continuing professional development. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Initial or pre-service training				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	-	1	1	1
Continuing professional development				

For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	-	1	1	1

*C3 Please indicate on which GCED and ESD themes pre-service or in-service training is available for teachers, trainers and educators at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*C4 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach the following dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	1
Skills	1	1	1	1
Values	1	1	1	1
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	1

*C5 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to use the following approaches to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	1
Cross curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher	1

D. Student assessment (paras 4 and 5 of the 1974 Recommendation)

D1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are covered in student assessments and examinations. Indicate whether students are assessed only on their knowledge of and skills related to the topics being tested or also on their values, attitudes and/or behaviours.

Due to the fact that school curriculum for **primary and secondary education** includes elements of ESD and GCED, specific topics related to them are reflected in the items on these subjects in all the exams and assessments (where the curriculum for the exams and assessments derives from the school's curriculum). Those items address especially knowledge and skills of high cognitive level like: evaluations, synthesis, modelling, problem-based situations etc.

Regarding the pupils' current assessment, all the school curriculum (for all the topics) contain values and attitudes related to the topic, so these aspects are included in the pupils' assessments at school level. Pupils are assessed only on their knowledge of and skills related to the topics being tested or also on their values, attitudes and/or behaviours, in respect with the specific of training programme.

Additionally, **Romania supports children and young people capable of high performance**. In order to achieve this, the Ministry of Education and Research organizes school and extracurricular competitions, profile camps, symposia and other specific activities and provides scholarships and other forms of material and financial support. The legal framework is ensured by the **Methodology - framework for the organization and conduct of school competitions and the Regulation for the organization of activities included in the calendar of educational, school and extracurricular activities**. Participation in school competitions is open to all students within primary to high-school education (secondary education), including those within VET. The calendars of competitions, including those related to extracurricular activities (projects based competitions), are annually approved by Minister Order. The competitions are organized on the basis of the curriculum and of complementary study programs, specific competition topics and specific bibliographies, among these being the global citizenship and sustainable development, in terms of contents, competencies, projects' themes. We mention some examples of such competitions: Olympiad for Geography, Earth Sciences, Economy, Civic education, Civic culture, "Young are debating" (Argumentation, debate and critical thinking), Religion, Environmental protection and also, examples of contests: National Contest for Environmental Projects; National Contest Global education, International Contest „Young People in European Forests - YPEF"; National Contest for Antidrug Projects ("Together" Projects); National Contests „Made for Europe", „Your gesture is important too"; „Earth is our home", „Children, save the Blue Planet", „Do everything to save Earth", „Edelweiss", "European School", "The Friends of the Nature", "The Friends of the Danube Delta".

Besides the competitions supported and organized at national level by MoER, contests at county or regional level can be organized by county school inspectorates in partnerships with public authorities, NGOs, etc. Examples of such competitions covering in an explicit manner the themes of GCED and ESD are: Regional Contest of literature INTERGALCULTURA; Sustainable development between identity and diversity; "PATHWAY TO FRIENDSHIP" Contest (in English); Geography Contests "Terra- from story to reality" and "Ecological".

For **IVET** system, learning outcomes included in the Training Standards, described through knowledge, skills and attitudes, are evaluated through Evaluation Standards. Each VET learning outcome unit is associated with an evaluation standard mentioning the conditions in which the achievement of the learning outcome unit is proven, namely:

- achievement criteria and their share – statements associated with learning outcomes, mentioning more exactly the student outcomes, by indicating some benchmarks to measure the performance level to which the competency is proven;
- achievement indicators and their share, by which each criterion is detailed, in relation with the learning outcomes and by which the level of knowledge, skills and attitudes achievement can be measured.

The Evaluation Standards can be used both in the formative evaluation, summative evaluation, as well as to certify the professional qualification addressing both the specialized contents and those related to also the specific contents related to ESD

In VET, the training and evaluation of key competencies are correlated, the evaluation being carried out according to the manner in which the training process was designed. From this perspective, the learning outcomes, expressed by knowledge, skills and attitudes, are integrating the 8 areas of key competencies. The certification examinations of the professional qualifications of level 3, 4 and 5 of the National Qualifications Framework also aim at the level of acquisition of knowledge, skills and attitudes regarding ESD.

In **higher education**, the students' evaluations and assessments include elements of GCED and ESD in terms of knowledge, skills, attitudes and behaviours both in specific study programmes addressing these topics as discussed above, as well as in other study programmes which include GCED and ESD in the broader educational approach employed.

*D2 Please indicate whether the GCED and ESD themes below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*D3 Please indicate which of the dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	1
Skills	1	1	1	1
Values	1	1	1	1
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	1

E. Mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in laws and policies, curriculum, teacher education and student assessment (paras 4-5, 7, 10-19 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

*E1 Based on your responses to questions in the previous four sections (laws and policies, curriculum, teacher education and student assessment) please indicate to what extent global citizenship education (GCED) and education for sustainable development (ESD) are mainstreamed⁴ in (a) education laws and policies, (b) curriculum (c) teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) and (d) student assessment in your country. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell in the table below.

KEY:

0 Not at all

1 Partially

2 Extensively

9 Not known

99 Not applicable

GCED and ESD are not mainstreamed.

Some GCED and/or ESD themes⁵ are mainstreamed. Select this option if GCED is mainstreamed but ESD is not (or vice versa).

Most GCED and ESD themes are mainstreamed.

It is not known whether GCED and ESD are mainstreamed or not.

The given level of government does not have responsibility for the given component (policies, curriculum, teacher education or student assessment) and/or does not have responsibility for the given level or type of education. This may occur at the national level in federal countries where education is the responsibility of individual states or at the sub-national level in small countries where there is only one level of government.

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
(a) Education laws and policies	2	2	2	2
(b) Curriculum	2	2	99	2
(c) Teacher education	1	2	2	2
(d) Student assessment	1	2	9	2
Sub-national				
(a) Education laws and policies	2	2	99	2
(b) Curriculum	2	2	1	1
(c) Teacher education	1	2	2	1
(d) Student assessment	1	2	9	1

⁴ GCED and ESD are mainstreamed if their themes are mentioned explicitly in relevant documents and are expected to be implemented by the relevant authorities (e.g. Ministries, regional or local education authorities), educational institutions (e.g. schools, colleges and universities) and/or education professionals (e.g. teachers, lecturers, trainers and educators) as appropriate.

⁵ Refer to the schema in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

F. Technical and vocational education and training (paras 25-29 of the 1974 Recommendation)

F1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in technical and vocational education and training. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

Initial vocational education and training provided in pre-university national education system is developed according the provisions of the Law of National Education and subsequent legislation mentioned in A1b paragraph.

Vocational education and training include several options. One option is to follow the vocational education paths as part of upper secondary education, which begins after completing the lower secondary education (eighth grade) and lasts for a minimum of three years. Another option is to take apprenticeship training courses (720 hours) after the tenth grade of highschoools (second year of the upper secondary education), the completion of which is mandatory in Romania. Post-secondary education is also available for professional development and is provided in highschoools, colleges and foremen schools for one to three years, depending on the specialization.

As part of the technical vocational education path of the upper secondary education, **ESD** elements are addressed specifically through the natural resources and environmental protection education programmes aim to develop competences in agriculture, silviculture, environmental protection and food industry, and include specialities such as environmental and environmental protection technician, hydrometeorology technician, forestry and logging technician and organic farming technician. The curriculum for grade 9 of the 4-year vocational education and training in environmental protection, adopted in 2016, consists of five modules with a total of 414 hours per year, of which 324 hours theoretical (216), technological laboratory (36) and practical training (72), and 90 hours of apprenticeship. Grade 10 studies consist of 5 modules (440 hours), including on environmental legislation. Grade 11 has seven modules (513 hours) and grade 12 has eight modules (428 hours), including on waste management and air, soil and water quality monitoring and control.

The training for all IVET qualifications (irrespective of duration) is provided based on the Training Standards which describe qualifications in terms of learning outcomes. The Training Standards for EQF level 3 and 4 were revised and approved by order of the minister no. 4121/13.06.2016 and where implemented starting with 2016-2017 school year. Key competences are integrated into general and specialized technical Learning Outcomes Units. Entrepreneurial skills are also developed by an interactive learning method - the training firms' method.

The training provided based on the Training Standards has a modular structure and cover specialized topic and various other topics related to sustainable development.

Among the initiatives developed at national level in order to promote GCED and/or ESD in technical and vocational education and training could be mentioned:

- Reviewing qualifications, training standards and curriculum by introducing green competencies with special relevance for energy efficiency, renewable energies, environmental protection, sustainable manufacturing, circular economy, processed products without additives and chemicals, efficient management of resources and a healthy lifestyle, plant cultivation and exploitation of agricultural lands, reduction of pollution.
- Developing key competencies (teamwork, communication skills, IT skills, entrepreneurial competence, etc.) and attitudes through interactive and participatory learning methods, such as the training firms. Through that VET students are trained for sustainable development, responsible participation, activ citizenship and a healthy lifestyle.
- Organizing VET schools in partenerial networks and developing an electronic communication platform where examples of good practices, curriculum documents,

learning materials, activities, etc. can be disseminated. Among the topics addressed are GCED and ESD.

- Organizing of thematic contest/competitions at local/regional/national level financed from public budget (practical examples: "The Sciences of the Earth" (interdisciplinary), "Business Plan", "Company of the Year", National Contest for Environmental Projects; International Contest „Young People in European Forests – YPEF”; National Contest for Antidrug Projects ("Together" Projects); National Contests „Made for Europe”, „Your gesture is important too”, „Earth is our home”, „Children, save the Blue Planet”, „Do everything to save Earth”, „Iedera, o piece of heaven”, „Edelweiss”, „Young are debating”, „European School”, „European Parliament Ambassador School”, „The Friends of the Nature”, „The Friends of the Danube Delta”).

Integrating the 3D laboratories in the process of continuous professional development of teacher, as well as inter and transdisciplinary approaches in the framework of VET curriculum.

G. Adult education (para 30 of the 1974 Recommendation)

G1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in adult education and other forms of non-formal education including youth education, out-of-school education, etc. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

- Adult education and youth projects (mobility, strategic partnerships and structure dialogue) are priority areas funded under the **Erasmus+ programme** and some of the projects address broadly topics pertaining to GCED and ESD. Among the eligible projects financed between 2017-2020 for adult education, we mention: "Let's warm-up the climate for social inclusion", "Improving disadvantaged adults' career - inclusion for all", "New approaches and skills for increasing social inclusion" etc. Types of eligible activities include: activities that promote the active participation of young people through their interaction with decision makers, activities that prioritize promoting the inclusion and professional integration of disadvantaged young people, activities that promote improving knowledge among young people seeking recognition and validation of non-formal learning at local, regional, national and European level, participation in non-formal education programs (youth exchanges), etc. (The lists of eligible projects financed under the "Adult education" priority of the Erasmus+ programme in Romania can be found here: <https://www.erasmusplus.ro/rezultate-selectie>).
- **Environmental education projects**, for example: "**Great National Environmental Volunteering for Schoolchildren**", which was funded by the "No PLANet B" project, carried out by the Call Service Association within an international partnership co-financed by the European Union through the DEAR program. The national environmental competition included 10 predefined environmental actions (greening, planting, recycling, non-formal environmental education sessions, etc.). During the 18 months of implementation, the project targeted 42,000 pupils from 105 school units across 22 counties. The participants implemented 6,858 activities of education and environment protection and 17 of the schools received prizes for their results, while 21 schools were awarded the "Eco School" label in recognition of their efforts to reduce their environmental impact.
- Projects to support **inclusive education**, for example: "**EduForm - Quality inclusive EDUcation through continuous professional training**" (budget of over 6.5 million euros), carried out by the Association "Spiru Haret National Society for Education Science and Culture", during 2018-2020, co-financed by the EU. The project aims to develop a partnership in order to implement a series of activities to enhance the professional and transversal skills of teachers and school managers in Ialomița and Caraș-Severin counties, which come from 23 disadvantaged schools, with mass or special education.

- Programmes and projects promoting **active citizenship with a whole community approach**, for example “**Project Citizen**”, designed by the American organization Center for Civic Education and implemented in Romania by Timișoara Intercultural Institute. The programme was developed in the early 2000s, but starting from 2017 it became a strategic partnership with the Romanian-American Foundation, aiming at supporting teachers in applying the principles and instruments included in the Council of Europe Reference Framework of Competences for Democratic Culture (2016) and the Council of the EU Recommendation on Common values, Inclusive Education, and the European Dimension of Teaching (2018). In 2017, based on an assessment of the previous stages of implementation, the programme underwent a revision in terms of methodology and working tools (including online platform, student manual and teacher guide, as well as support materials). So far, face-to-face training courses have been organized in Bucharest (for teachers from Bucharest and Ilfov County) and in Caraș-Severin, Cluj, Constanta, Galați, Hunedoara, Iași, Brașov, Timiș (for teachers from Timiș and Arad) and Suceava counties. An online course is available for teachers from other counties every year. Details about the Programme *Project Citizen* are available here: <https://cetateanul.intercultural.ro/despre-program/>.
- Additionally, GCED and ESD topics are addressed through broad initiatives of civic and private environmental education and intervention, such as: ecology news portal <https://www.ecomagazin.ro/>, private funding for environmental projects, for example: Lidl Romania, <http://www.romaniapozitiva.ro/romania-pozitiva/770-000-euro-in-projete-de-educatie-si-medi/>, OMV „Țara lui Andrei” funding programme <https://www.taraluiandrei.ro/idei-din-tla> etc. Moreover, non-reimbursable funding for NGOs promoting non-formal education initiatives are available through EEA and Norwegian grants, for projects promoting active citizenship: <https://www.eeagrants.ro/programe/cetatenie-activa/descriere-cetatenie-activa> or environmental protection: <https://www.eeagrants.ro/programe/mediu/descriere-mediu>.

H. Research and International Co-operation (paras 41-45 of the 1974 Recommendation)

H1 Please describe what kinds of research or experimentation have been carried out to improve the implementation of GCED and/or ESD. Describe briefly how the results of such activities have influenced education policies, curriculum and/or teaching practices.

We present below some examples of projects carried out in order to identify best practices pertaining to GCED and ESD, which resulted in further mainstreaming them in teaching and learning process:

- **Research project “Ways to optimize educational interventions for children from refugee families or benefiting from international protection”** (implemented by the Institute of Educational Sciences, within the MoER, 2017). The research aimed to summarize information on educational barriers to the integration of children from refugee families or who have applied for this status and are in the evaluation stage of the process, and to look for solutions for the host school communities. The research results included: 8 analyzes / studies of European policies and good practices in the field of school integration of vulnerable socio-cultural and linguistic groups; a case study on Romania and Recommendations. The study points to the need for coherence of educational policies in the broader context of the European and national immigration strategy and calls for rapid access to education for these minors at national level, for a uniform and coherent process that generates equal opportunities and quality pedagogy. As a result of this project, the methodology and the Romanian language curriculum for refugees were revised: *Romanian language - introductory course for foreigner adult who have acquired a form of international protection in Romania and third country nationals and Romanian*

language - introductory course for foreigner children who have acquired a form of international protection in Romania and third-country nationals.

- **The project *Democratic school governance for inclusion: a whole community approach*** (2017), carried out in partnership with institutions from 5 other European countries, with the support of the Council of Europe and the EU. The project aimed at summarize the analyzed information on the socio-educational situation of different groups / categories of young people in marginal positions: Roma, children / young people with disabilities, refugees (immigrants). Subsequently, the project considered experimenting with the approach / involvement of the "whole community" from the perspective of social inclusion, focusing on the inclusion of refugee children studying in Romanian schools.

In the research activities carried out in the national institutes of research, preserving the environment is a priority of all current policies in the context of massive investments to be made in depollution and recycling techniques, in the management of water resources and wetlands. The "smart city" concept offers integrated infrastructure solutions for the needs of the population in urban agglomerations. The field of bioeconomy benefits from the huge potential of Romanian agriculture, in the context of an increasingly active and growing local food industry, of successful applied research in the field and in the pharmaceutical industry, as well as in the context of global trends such as high food demand. Food safety and optimization, the development of the horticultural, forestry, animal husbandry and fisheries sectors or the capitalization of biomass and biofuels are subdomains with obvious potential. Research in the field of energy supports the reduction of Romania's energy dependence, through the superior capitalization of fossil fuels, the diversification of national sources (nuclear, renewable, clean), multifunctional transport ("smart grids") and the increase of consumer efficiency.

We mention also specific research projects in the field of natural sciences, having as generic theme "**environmental protection**", carried out by the National Research and Development Institute for Environmental Protection (INCDPM). Some examples include: "Research to support capacity assessment and mitigation of climate change and other stressors on the state of forest ecosystems and vineyards", funded by the Ministry of Research and Innovation (currently MoER) (2017-2020); "Technologies for the recovery of urban sewage sludge and municipal waste", funded by the Ministry of Research and Innovation (currently MoER) (2017-2018), "Integrated and sustainable processes for environmental cleaning, reuse of wastewater and waste recovery" , funded by the Executive Unit for Funding Higher Education, Research, Development and Innovation (UEFISCDI (2018-2020).

Research and development specifically on GCED and ESD is not included as separate themes in the national research programmes. Such research takes place through national and international projects, activities of the ministries in charge of education and of the environment, and as a result of NGO work. Nevertheless, the topics mentioned above are part of specific study programmes in higher education institutions, thus addressing GCED and ESD from the perspective of skills and knowledge.

International cooperation:

- **eTwinning projects**, developed under the eTwinning Actions, part of the Lifelong Learning Program initiated by the European Commission, promote international cooperation, involving schools from different European countries. These projects have a strong intercultural dimension, thus mainstreaming themes of GCED. Participation in international eTwinning projects has had a significant impact on educational practices. The integration of information technology in project teaching and learning in schools in the international eTwinning community has been extensively addressed, increasing exponentially from 2007 to the present. Currently, there are over 31,000 Romanian teachers involved in eTwinning projects.

- **The PULCHRA project** is a complex, international initiative (10 partner countries, including Romania), funded by the EU through Horizon 2020. The project aims at enabling pupils, in collaboration with teachers, scientists, parents, to explore the scientific approach in a practical and applied manner. Among the possible topics for work are also the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). The implementation of the project will raise awareness among participants and the public of the connection between human actions and the urban ecosystem, thus mainstreaming GCED and ESD in Romanian schools. The project was started in 2019 and is ongoing (until 2022).

H2 Please indicate which types of activities are available that promote international co-operation at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Hosting of international meetings on GCED and/or ESD	1	1	1	1
Participation in international meetings abroad on GCED and/or ESD	1	1	1	1
Support for programmes hosting foreign students, researchers and/or teachers	1	1	1	1
Membership of international networks including ASPnet	9	9	1	9
Joint research projects on GCED and/or ESD with foreign institutions	1	1	1	1
Other activities (please specify):				

I. Any other comments

- 11 Please indicate whether your country has faced any constraints, in particular related to global or national crises, including natural disasters, in implementing the 1974 Recommendation during the reporting period.

The Covid-19 pandemic raised significant challenges in terms of ensuring the continuity and quality access to education. However, the broad strategy adopted by the Romanian Government and by the Ministry of Education and Research in particular to mitigate the effects of the crisis highlighted the benefits of international cooperation and understanding, thus actively promoting GCED and ESD through the specific activities implemented.

For example, in order to limit the negative impact on the education system with regard to the difficult access to educational resources, the MoER launched, shortly after the suspension of face-to-face courses, the “TeleȘcoala” (*TeleSchool*) program – an educational programme implemented in partnership with the Romanian Public Television (TVR), broadcasting lessons for terminal pupils in order to prepare them for the national exams. “TeleȘcoala” continues in the current school year.

Through the implementation of the National Programme Home School, electronic devices connected to the internet have been purchased in view of facilitating distance learning activities for pupils from disadvantaged backgrounds.

The national Programme “Safe school” also allows for the purchase of electronic devices for equipping schools in order to ensure the adequate provision of online education.

Recently, the MoER has initiated a Memorandum on the provision of internet connection for a number of pre-university educational establishments through a voluntary support programme. Within this Programme the Romanian Government with support from the electronic communication operators and the concerned industry in Romania, will ensure the prerequisites for urgently connecting the pre-university school establishments to internet.

- 12 Please provide any other relevant information or clarifications regarding the implementation of the 1974 Recommendation or the mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in your country's education system.